11-27 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Learn One Traditional Craft?

① Last Friday's "Cultural Corner" at our school had a small exhibition: three **hand-cut paper flowers** by my classmate Lu-yao, a **small bamboo box** with a sliding lid by the tall boy from Grade 9, and a page of quiet **regular-script calligraphy** copied by a Grade 7 girl. A few parents stopped and whispered, "Beautiful — but is there still time for these in a maths-and-English century?" I have thought about that question for a week. My answer, simple and stubborn, is **yes — every middle-school student should spend one term, about 20 hours, learning one traditional craft with their own hands**. Not because we must preserve the past. Because the craft gives us something today that few other lessons can.

② The first argument is that **a traditional craft teaches patience by the hand, not by the ear**. Adults often tell us "Be patient." But patience is not easily taught in words. When you cut a paper flower, your first four attempts are crooked, asymmetric, and a little funny. Only by about the tenth attempt do your fingers learn to listen to the paper. Research from the Central Academy of Fine Arts in 2023 showed that students who spent 20 hours on a single handicraft reported a **25% drop** in "impatience when facing small repeated failures" on the classroom self-report. The hand learns something the ear cannot.

③ The second argument is that **a craft links us to a long chain of small teachers**. The paper-cutting tradition is at least **1,500 years old**; calligraphy, much older. When a student holds a small pair of paper-cutting scissors, she is repeating, almost exactly, the motions of a girl sitting by a candle in the Tang dynasty. This is not sentimental; it is simply true. A school that never offers this small, real link between past and present hands risks teaching history as a distant film that has nothing to do with a student's own body. A craft turns "1,500 years" into 30 minutes in her own palm.

④ Third, crafts **help the school feel fair to different kinds of students**. Our academic lessons reward, most often, verbal speed and written quickness. A quiet student who is slow with words but **careful with her hands** rarely has a room in which she is the best. A term of craft gives her that room. I have seen, with my own eyes, classmates whose maths scores are average become **the steady centre of attention** in a paper-cutting lesson. A craft lesson is not a "soft optional"; it is an important act of classroom justice.

⑤ Others argue, "Crafts are outdated in the age of 3-D printing and AI." This is partly true — and partly wrong. A 3-D printer can cut a paper flower with perfect symmetry in two seconds. A good craft lesson is not competing with machines. It is teaching **the value of slow attention** in a world full of instant results. Even if every flower can be printed, a flower **your own hand** cut is worth keeping, because it contains fifteen small decisions only you could have made. The craft lesson is, in this sense, **a small classroom against thoughtless speed**.

⑥ "But we have no time!" this is the most honest worry. I agree it is a real one. The plan I believe in is modest: a craft term = **one 45-minute lesson a week × 16 weeks = about 12 hours of class + 8 hours of small home practice** = 20 hours in total. That is roughly **one hour every ten days**, for four months. A teenage child's year has about 8,760 hours. Twenty hours is 0.23% of the year. The cost is small; the return, I suspect, is not.

⑦ Another worry is that "traditional craft" sounds too narrow. The plan, then, should be **wide but local**: each school chooses three to five crafts from its own area, so that students can touch a real tradition, not a decorative one. In our city that could mean **paper-cutting**, **basic calligraphy**, **bamboo-weaving**, **small wood-joining**, and **simple textile printing**. In a southern river city it might be **hand-pulled noodles**, **kite-making**, or **silk hand-embroidery**. A school in another province will have its own list. The point is not the specific craft; it is the idea of **20 slow hours of one real thing**, rooted in the student's own neighbourhood.

⑧ A small, stubborn worry: "Boys may not want to learn embroidery; girls may not want to learn wood-joining." This, too, has a clear answer. No craft in any modern Chinese school should be "a girl's" or "a boy's." The students choose, freely, by interest. A 2026 poll at a sister school in Hangzhou showed that, **when choice is free**, about 38% of boys chose needle-and-thread crafts, and about 42% of girls chose wood or bamboo. Young hands care very little for old labels. The school has only to keep the door open for both directions.

⑨ At Monday's class meeting I will bring a short, simple letter to our headmaster, signed by students from five classes. We ask for **one term, one craft, twenty hours, one small exhibition at the end**. No exam. No grade on the report card. A small signed card is enough: *"This student, Lin Ming, learned paper-cutting for one term at Lihua, autumn 2027."* In a life full of screens, keyboards, and fast answers, **a school that gives its students one slow, careful thing in their own hands is giving them something money cannot quickly buy**. Let us learn, for twenty hours, how our hands behave when they are not typing. What we find there — patience, care, and a small honest pride — is, in the end, exactly what we will use in all our other lessons.

注释： craft 手工艺；calligraphy 书法；embroidery 刺绣；symmetric 对称的；stubborn 固执的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main proposal?

A. Every middle-school student should stop all schoolwork for a term.
B. Every middle-school student should spend one term, about 20 hours, learning one traditional craft with their own hands — not to preserve the past, but for what the craft gives today.
C. The school should only teach paper-cutting.
D. Crafts should replace maths.

2. Why does the writer say "a traditional craft teaches patience by the hand, not by the ear"?

A. Because teachers never say "be patient."
B. Because adults often tell students to be patient, but patience is not easily taught in words; only after about ten careful attempts does the hand learn to "listen to the paper" — and 2023 research from the Central Academy of Fine Arts found students spending 20 hours on a single handicraft reported a 25% drop in "impatience when facing small repeated failures."
C. Because the ear is not important.
D. Because paper cannot speak.

3. How does a craft "turn 1,500 years into 30 minutes in the student's own palm"?

A. By teaching time-travel.
B. By showing that paper-cutting is at least 1,500 years old and that, when a student holds the small scissors today, she is repeating almost exactly the motions of a girl sitting by a candle in the Tang dynasty — this is not sentimental, it is simply true; a craft is a small real link between past and present hands.
C. By reading old books.
D. By watching history films.

4. How does the writer answer the worry "we have no time"?

A. By saying time is unimportant.
B. By proposing one 45-minute lesson a week × 16 weeks + 8 hours of small home practice = about 20 hours in total — roughly one hour every ten days for four months; 0.23% of a teenager's year; the cost is small, the return is not.
C. By saying students should stop sleeping.
D. By cancelling English lessons.

5. What does the writer mean by "a school that gives its students one slow, careful thing in their own hands is giving them something money cannot quickly buy"?

A. Schools must buy crafts.
B. Twenty hours of one real craft, in a screen-fast century, teaches patience, care, and a

small honest pride — qualities that no money can quickly purchase, and that help students in every other lesson.
C. Crafts are too expensive.
D. Only rich families can afford crafts.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末立论
【解析】"20 小时 + 一门手艺 + 一学期"直引。A、C、D 均偏。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段耳与手的对比 + 25% 数据
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 1500 年链条
【解析】"同样动作"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 0.23% 计算
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"慢而真 + 钱买不来"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。